Powassan & District Union Public Library

Minutes for Monday, February 23, 2026 – 6:15 p.m.

Board Meeting @ Library

In-person: Debbie Piper, Randy Hall, Steve Kirkey, Bernadette Kerr, Jennie Leblond, Pat Stephens, Larry Woodword, Marie Rosset

Absent with regrets: Valerie Morgan

Recording of meeting

Item	Action	Responsibility
1. Call to order	6:12 pm	
2. Respect and Acknowledgement Declaration	Declaration read by CEO We respectfully acknowledge that we are on the traditional territory of the Anishinaabe Peoples, in the Robinson-Huron and Williams Treaties areas. We wish to acknowledge the long history of First Nations and Métis Peoples in Ontario and show respect to the neighbouring Indigenous communities. We offer our gratitude for their care for, and teachings about, our earth and our relations. May we continue to honour these teachings and recognize their value going forward.	
3. General Consent Motion: Presented the general Consent Motion for January 2026, which includes: a) Approval of the February 23, 2026 Agenda b) Approval of Minutes from the January 19, 2026 meeting c) Approval of the January 2026 Financial Statements d) Approval of the January 2026 Library Reports	**Motion: 2026-04** **That the General Consent Motion for February 2026 be adopted as amended.** **Moved by**: Bernadette Kerr **Seconded by**: Jenny Leblond Carried.	
4. Disclosure of pecuniary Interest	None	
5. Business a) Update on hiring of new CEO	The job ad is ready to post, will go out early March. Goal is to interview in April and May 2026 Councillor Hall suggested that to save money, library do away with a CEO and hire a Head Librarian instead. Discussion ensued, with C. Hall recommending municipal CAOs take on a bigger	Hiring Committee

	role in the operation of the library with payroll, HR, and benefits being delegated to municipalities. Long discussion ensued. Upon further investigation, a Library CEO is mandatory according to the Library Act, Section 15(2) Chief Executive Officer (2) A board shall appoint a chief executive officer who shall have general supervision over and direction of the operations of the public library and its staff, shall attend all board meetings and shall have the other powers and duties that the board assigns to him or her from time to time. R.S.O. 1990, c. P.44, s. 15 (2).	
b) Recruitment of New Board members	- Councillor Hall informed the Board that Municipality of Powassan received several applications to join Library Board. Candidates were selected at their last Council meeting.	
c) Report from Councillor Hall to Library Board on results of cost analysis for Powassan to fund its own standalone library and withdraw from the Union.	Given that there is no space at 250 Clark among other consideration, See 5a). Councillor Hall found that withdrawing from the Union was not feasible. He did agree to find the cost of having Powassan do payroll, and HR. Benefits are already being provided by Powassan. As for other shared expenses see 5d)	Councillor Hall
d) Partnerships Review	At the request of Councillor Hall, CEO presented reasoning behind using independent providers of services • Plowing: MoP quote $115/plow Jeff Towns:$50/plow • IT services: Cousineau Services $30/hour Terry Lang : >$30 • Insurance : yearly costs are comparable MOP Deductable: $10,000 Cooperators: $1,000 • Grass cutting: student $17.60/hr • Snow shoveling: Kevin Topham $20/day • HR Payroll: ADP ($43.53 + 3.30/empl.)/payroll Also includes T4s, help on demand, webinars on new legislations etc. Councillor Hall will inquire cost of MoP fee for same service	

	• General HR: CEO with advice from Library Board/no extra cost. Councillor Hall will inquire about MoP cost • Grant writing: idea is to write grants to benefit three Municipality. Many grants are very specific in that they are for only one project i.e. OTF, they specify one organization – one project. Library willing to entertain applying to grants which will benefit all three Union Members. Library Staff limited in time to take on exercise.	Randy Hall
e) Grants update	• PDUPL will be applying for the **2026 OTF Capital Grant** to repair and bring up to code their elevator through the Township of Nipissing. Kim Turnbull will be working with CEO to complete application by March 4, 2026. • Seniors Community Grant application – pending • Canada Summer Job (CSJ) – pending • Art Council of Ontario – application for funding submitted Feb 18.	
f) Library Agreement Renewal Update	Progressing, currently proposed distribution of fees stands at 60% Powassan, 22% Nipissing, 18% Chisholm. Still needs ratification from Chisholm Council.	
g) Upcoming Activities	March Break Activities, CEO distributed handout describing activities. March 16: St Pats activities March 17: Silent Dance Party in partnership with 250 GAP program March 18: Skate Event March 19: Steven Morrin – wild animal Presentation March 20: Mini Olympics April 7: special presentation on local Hospice care April 28: presentation of MAiD with Dr. Gauthier	
6. Correspondence	Resolution from Council of Nipissing agreeing to a 22% portion of the PDUPL 2026 levy.	

7. Committee Reports a) Property Committee	- Working on OTF Capital Grant application to repair and bring up to code the PDUPL elevator. Water proofing of elevator well will be included in grant application.	CEO
b) Financial Committee	- The Budget was sent out to three municipalities – approval pending. - Audit is scheduled for the week of March 9th to 13th, with final report presented at the April 20, meeting.	CEO
c) Policy Committee	- GOV-01 Board Terms of reference PDUPL Scheduling and starting time of meetings modified **Motion: 2026-05** **That GOV-01 Board Terms of reference PDUPL be adopted as modified.** **Moved by**: Pat Stephens **Seconded by**: Larry Woodward Carried. - GOV-02 Board Directors Duties and Responsibilities. – reviewed and left as is. - RES-20 Artificial (AI) Policy – deferred until April 2026 - Generative Artificial Intelligence (GenAI) – deferred until April 2026	
d) Friends of the Library	- Friends agreed to cover the cost of shelving and fireplace surround in Enever Room - Will cover cost of new faucet and counter in kitchen	CEO and friends
8. Adjournment	**Motion: 2026-03** That the February 23, 2026, meeting be adjourned at 8:04 pm. **Moved by**: Bernadette Kerr	Next meeting: March 16, 2026, at 6:15 pm

Chair: _____ **Recorder:** _____

Debbie Piper **Marie Rosset, CEO**